

BM3 — Lesson 3: The Centurion

Faith That Commands Results



Theme: Trusting Jesus' Word



Background Text: Matthew 8:5–13; Luke 7:1–10



Key Verse: Matthew 8:10 (WEB)

When Jesus heard it, he marveled, and said... ‘Most certainly I tell you, I haven’t found so great a faith, not even in Israel.’



Faith that trusts the Word, not the circumstances.



Appetizer – The Power of the Word, Matt 8:5–8

⁵ When he came into Capernaum, a centurion came to him, asking him for help, ⁶ saying, “Lord, my servant lies in the house paralyzed, grievously tormented.” ⁷ Jesus said to him, “**I will come and heal him.**” The centurion answered, ‘Lord, I’m not worthy for you to come under my roof. Just say the word, and my servant will be healed.’

The centurion didn’t ask Jesus for a visit—he asked Him for a word. He believed that one word from Jesus could travel farther and work faster than any doctor, medicine, or ritual.

The centurion refused to overlook his servant’s need but rather recognized that compassion and action were needed for relief. Faith sometimes starts with one simple cry: “Lord, I need You.”



Reflection Question:

If you could ask Jesus for help in one situation right now, what would it be?



Main Course



Bite 1 – Faith That Understands Authority, Matt 8:8–9a

The centurion answered, “Lord, I’m not worthy for you to come under my roof. Just say the word, and my servant will be healed. For I also am a man under authority, having under myself soldiers. I tell this one, ‘Go,’ and he goes...”

He didn’t need Jesus to walk to his house. He understood that if Jesus had authority, then His word was enough—even from a distance. Real faith doesn’t always need a physical sign. It trusts that when Jesus speaks, it’s already done.

 Reflection Question:

Do you sometimes feel like you need to “feel something” for your prayers to work? What would it look like to trust God’s Word even when you don’t feel anything?

 Bite 2 – Faith That Amazed Jesus, Matt 8:10, 13

When Jesus heard it, he marveled... “I haven’t found so great a faith, not even in Israel.” ... Jesus said to the centurion, “Go your way. As you have believed, so be it done for you.” His servant was healed in that hour.

Jesus was amazed at this man’s faith. Not because he was perfect or religious, but because he believed Jesus’ word completely. Your background doesn’t limit your faith.

 Author’s Commentary

Jesus is moved by trust, not titles. Aligning with the Great "I AM" starts with your words. Think about it: in the very first chapter of the Bible, the Creator didn’t use hands or tools to build the universe—He spoke ten times, and reality shifted.

Proverbs 18:21 tells us that life and death are held in the power of the tongue, and Isaiah 55:11 explains the authority behind that release. The Centurion understood the assignment. He knew that while "laying on of hands" might make people feel better, the real work happens when a word is released. He didn't need a ritual; he just needed a command. That word ricochets through eternity until it hits the target.

In the modern world, we say "Say Less"—because when you are walking in strong faith, you don’t need a long speech. That level of trust was the "IT" factor that turned his request into a power move.

 Youth Check-In (YES/NO):

Do you believe that Jesus can move in situations you can’t physically control?

☐ YES ☐ NO  **Reflection Question:**

Where do you need to trust Jesus at a distance—where you can’t personally fix it?

Bite 3 –The Sent Word, John 1:1,14

1 In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. ¹⁴ And the Word was made flesh, and dwelt among us, (and we beheld his glory, the glory as of the only begotten of the Father,) full of grace and truth.

The centurion had many reasons why he didn't believe Jesus needed to physically come, but Emmanuel, was happy someone caught the revelation. When he sent the word, he sent HIMSELF, because he was and is the Word! Whew...

Author's Commentary

Being a high-ranking commander in the Roman Empire didn't make the Centurion a villain—it gave him a platform. Instead of using his power to hurt people, he leveraged it to help them. That's why others were so quick to vouch for his character and tell Jesus why he deserved a hand.'

But here's the real power move: despite his status, he was completely humble. He didn't think his "good guy" resume or his high-level titles made him worthy of having God in the flesh walk through his front door. It was as if he said, "With all my accolades, I'm still not worthy—but I'm asking anyway. If You just say the word, that's all I need." **Faith isn't just about your miracle; it's also about how God wants to use you to stand in the gap for others.**

Reflection Question:

Who could you be praying for or believing for, like the centurion did for his servant?

Dessert – Beyond a Resume - A Word Is Enough

Jesus didn't respond to the wealth, the power, or the "good guy" resume. He responded to a heart in need. When we say "Amen," we are literally saying **"It is so."** It's the moment we stop looking for a physical sign and come into total agreement with what God has already spoken. The Centurion didn't need a visit; he just needed a Word. He knew that once the Word was released, the shift was already final.

Youth Check-in:

Write a one-sentence declaration of faith that starts with:

"Jesus, Your word is enough for _____."

To-Go Box

- Faith trusts Jesus' authority even at a distance.
 - Jesus is moved by trust, not by status or background.
 - You can use your faith to intercede for others, not just yourself.
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Prayer

"Jesus, thank You for showing me the centurion's example. Help me trust Your word even when I don't see or feel immediate change. Grow my faith so that it not only covers my life, but also the lives of people I care about. In Your name, amen."

Personal Prayer Space

Write a prayer for someone else who needs Jesus' help, like the centurion's servant did:

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. The centurion's faith worked even at a _____.
 2. Jesus said, "I have not found anyone in Israel with such great _____."
 3. True faith doesn't need evidence; it trusts the _____.
 4. The centurion understood the power of _____.
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Notes Section — Group Discussion & Personal Study

Why Soul Food?



Dr. Dee Brown
Series Founder

Growing up in Boston, my grandmother, Pastor Pearl Doctor, **always brought both the food and the Word to the table.** You couldn't walk into her home without smelling something cooking and hearing something spiritual on the radio. Whether you came in upset, excited, nervous, or afraid, she would bring you back to center—with the Word of God in one hand and a plate of food in the other.

She didn't wait until Sunday to offer support. She lived what I now call: ***Truth Served Daily***—sharing God's Word like Heavenly bread alongside whatever she had on the stove. I watched family, and friends, alike find peace in that kind of soul food, the kind that nourishes the inner person and prepares us for more than the moment we're in.

This Soul Food Bible Study workbook was born from that legacy. Designed for **personal devotion or Bible study circles, use in cell group ministry, and Sunday school settings**, each lesson offers bite-sized, life-giving “courses” to help you grow in wholeness, deepen fellowship, and share what God is doing in you with others. My hope is that these pages bring comfort, clarity, and courage—and inspire you to pass that soul food along. Be blessed!



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